# Term Plan 2026

Grade 5 · English (Home Language) · South Africa · Intermediate Phase

This plan tells the class teacher what English lessons cover in each of the four terms. It is written week by week in plain paragraphs. Each paragraph names the focus of the weeks and what learners do. Reading, writing, language and speaking and listening are taught together, so one week often touches more than one of them.

Learners have five English lessons a week. Two are for reading, one is for writing, one is for language work and one is for talking and listening. Teachers may swap lessons within a week, but the order of the focus topics stays the same.

A topic that appears in two terms is taught again on purpose, at a deeper level the second time. A topic that belongs to a different grade is mentioned only so that teachers know it is not part of this year.

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## Term 1

**Weeks 1 and 2.** The focus is story elements: characters, setting and plot. Learners read two short stories aloud in pairs, then talk about who the characters are, where the story happens and what happens first, next and last. They fill in a simple story map.

**Weeks 3 and 4.** The focus is nouns, verbs and adjectives. Learners sort words from the stories they have read, build sentences with colourful adjectives and play a word-class game in groups.

**Weeks 5 to 7.** The focus is writing a recount. Learners tell what they did on a school trip or a weekend, plan it in order, write a first draft, check it with a partner and write it out neatly.

**Weeks 8 to 10.** The focus is show and tell talks. Each learner brings one object from home and speaks about it for one minute while the class listens and asks one question.

## Term 2

**Weeks 1 to 3.** The focus is poems and rhyme. Learners listen to and read four short poems, find the rhyming words, clap the rhythm and perform a poem aloud for the class.

**Weeks 4 and 5.** The focus is using capital letters and punctuation. Learners practise capital letters for names and places, and full stops, question marks and commas in short texts they correct.

**Weeks 6 and 7.** The focus is writing a paragraph. Learners learn that a paragraph has a topic sentence, supporting sentences and an ending sentence, and write one paragraph about an animal they like.

**Weeks 8 and 9.** The focus is listening to instructions. Learners follow spoken steps to draw, build or fold something, and then give a set of spoken steps to a partner.

## Term 3

**Weeks 1 and 2.** The focus is writing a paragraph again. Learners write two linked paragraphs, one after the other, and learn to use joining words such as first, then and finally. This builds on the paragraph work of Term 2.

**Weeks 3 to 5.** The focus is reading for information from non-fiction texts. Learners read a fact page about a country or an animal, find the headings and captions, and answer questions with the help of the text.

**Weeks 6 and 7.** The focus is tenses: past, present and future. Learners change sentences from one tense to another and write a short diary entry in the past tense.

**Weeks 8 to 10.** The focus is writing a letter to a friend. Learners learn the parts of a friendly letter, write one and swap it with a partner who writes a reply.

## Term 4

**Weeks 1 to 3.** The focus is reading a longer story. The class reads one short novel together, a chapter at a time, and keeps a reading journal of favourite parts and new words.

**Weeks 4 and 5.** The focus is prepositions and conjunctions. Learners find words that tell where things are, and words such as and, but and because that join ideas, then use them in their own sentences.

**Weeks 6 and 7.** The focus is writing a story. Learners plan a story with a beginning, a problem and an ending, write it over two lessons and share it in a reading circle. Writing a formal essay is a Grade 7 skill and is not taught this year, so learners should not be asked to write one.

**Week 8.** The focus is a class debate. Two teams speak for and against a simple idea, such as whether pets should be allowed in school, and every learner speaks at least once.

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